

Mining for gems

Revealing the treasures of the Earth

Large-scale mining for precious materials is mainly reserved for “big names”, such as gold, silver, and diamonds, as well as less precious material used in industry, such as copper. Some large-scale mines also produce fine gem material, such as malachite and turquoise, as by-products. Much gem mining is relatively small scale, however, and is often done using only hand tools.

The Superpit Located in Kalgoorlie in central Western Australia, the Superpit is Australia’s largest open pit gold mine and is one of the largest open pit mines in the world.

